another plan to finish me off as soon as possible. This information was passed on to us by one of our sources.

During the next three to four months, we notched up many more successes in our operations against the terrorists. More than seventy young men who had gone across the border for training and come back with an AK-47, deserted the ranks of their 'tanzeems'. They had realized the futility of their mission, and surrendered to my battalions. To avoid the penalty of Rs 20,000 that would have to be paid to the 'tanzeem' towards the cost of the gun, they asked our troops to enact a kind of drama and capture them from pre-arranged spots. As an incentive, we helped to secure jobs for them in the Uri civil power project being executed by a Swedish company in 1991–92. Some of them were appointed as security guards! Today, we have a surrender policy under which these misguided young men are rehabilitated so that they can join the national mainstream.

In November 1991, we were delighted to receive this telegram from the chief of the army staff:

> REFERENCE OPERATIONS OF 79 MTN BDE IN OP MOUSETRAP II ON 22 AND 23 NOV 91 (.) REQUEST CONVEY APPRECIATION AND CONGRATULATIONS OF CHIEF OF THE ARMY STAFF TO CONCERNED TROOPS IN OP MOUSETRAP II.